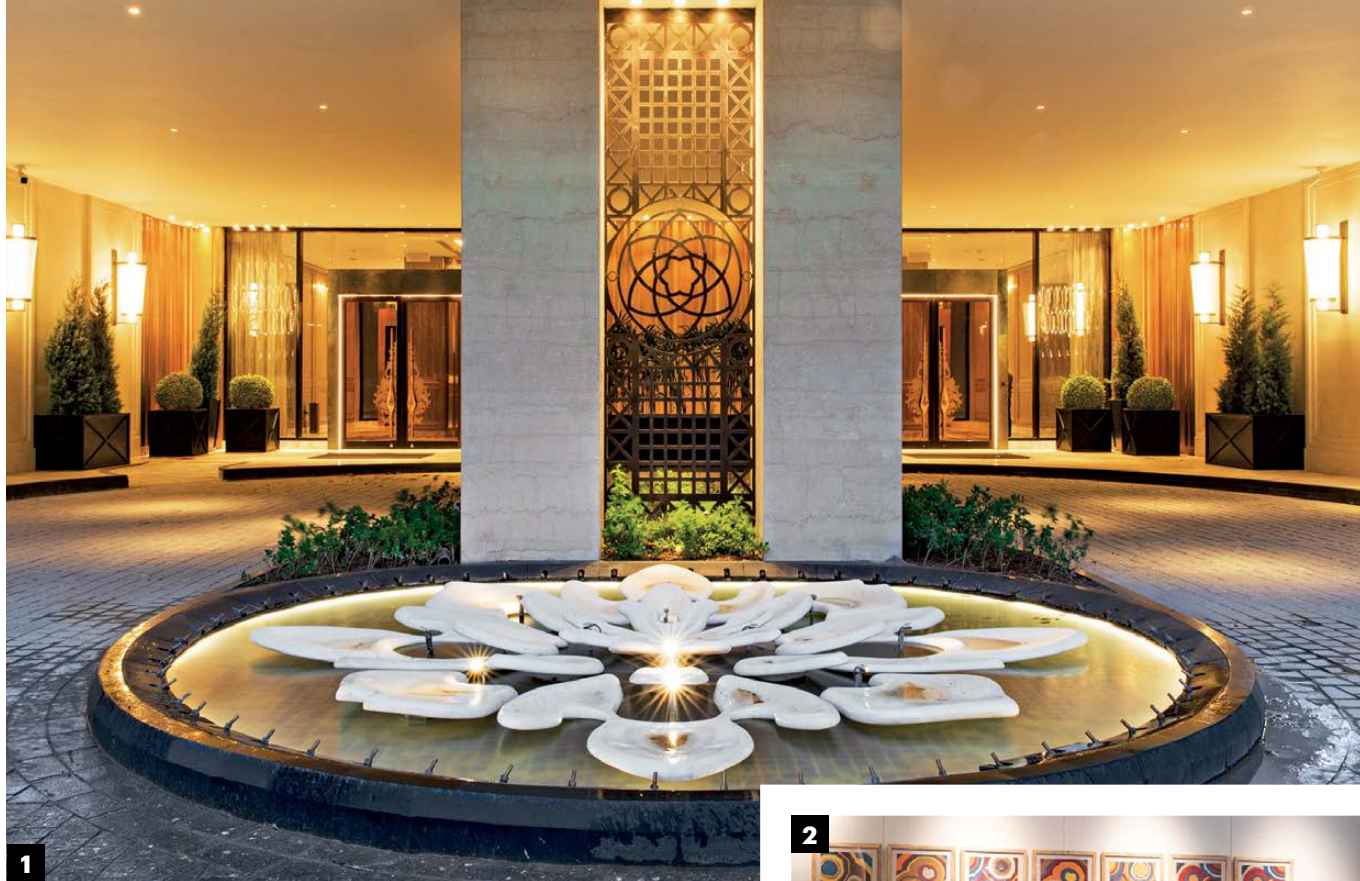




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116 | related disruptions resulted in a transition that contributed to the rise in luxury home sales in India, according to Akash Ohri, Joint Managing Director and Chief Business Officer, DLF Homes Developers. “Covid-19 marked a turning point in how homebuyers perceive their homes, and we quickly adapted to meet these changing needs. What was once just a place to retreat after a busy day has now become the epicentre of our lives. This shift challenged us, but it also gave us the opportunity to reshape our offerings and cater to a new mindset,” Ohri tells *Business Today*.

But what changed? “Today’s buyers want more than just a beautiful home—they want expansive spaces, flexibility for hybrid work, wellness, and above all, an enhanced lifestyle,” Ohri adds.

DLF, THE LARGEST luxury home developer in the country, recognised the trend early. Luxury has transcended beyond the materials and the design of the property, says Ohri. True luxury now encompasses a holistic experience—one that features unmatched services, outstanding hospitality, and an emphasis on health and wellness. “This is embedded in our DNA. We have always believed that a luxury home is about more than brick and mortar; it’s about the quality of life it offers. Globally, the ultra-luxury real estate market has seen a significant shift toward experience-driven living. Buyers are increasingly seeking homes that offer more than just a status symbol; they are looking for spaces that cater to their personal well-being, lifestyle, and convenience,” he says.

Capitalising on the boom in luxury home sales and leveraging its early-mover advantage, DLF has successfully sold some ₹22,000 crore worth of luxury homes in the past 15 months across three major

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PHOTO BY **HARDIK CHHABRA**

projects: The Arbour, DLF Privana West, and DLF Privana South. One area experiencing a convergence of India’s ultra-high-net-worth individuals (UHNIs) is along Gurugram’s Golf Course Road. Once an emerging market, Gurugram has now established itself as a formidable competitor to Mumbai in terms of pricing of luxury real estate.

But that’s not all. The NCR market, which is the second-largest luxury market in the country after the Mumbai Met-